

TotalBiz Email Setup & Disaster Recovery Guide

Architecture, DNS Configuration, SMTP Settings, and Emergency Troubleshooting

Primary Domain: totalbiz.co.uk Business Email: alex@totalbiz.co.uk Forwarding Destination: totalbizsupport@gmail.com

PANIC BUTTON: "I'm Not Receiving Emails!" (Check This First)

If emails sent to alex@totalbiz.co.uk are suddenly bouncing or not arriving in your Gmail inbox, run through this 2-minute diagnostic sequence before changing any settings:

- Step 1 (Check Cloudflare Activity):** Log into Cloudflare > Select totalbiz.co.uk > Email > Activity Log. Look at the Result column.
 - If it says Forwarded (green): Cloudflare delivered it to Gmail. Check Gmail's Spam or All Mail folders.
 - If it says Delivery failed (421): Gmail is temporarily rate-limiting Cloudflare's shared IPs. Do not touch DNS. Cloudflare will automatically queue and retry delivery over the next 1–2 hours.
- Step 2 (Check Destination Address):** In Cloudflare, go to Email Routing > Routing Rules. Verify that rule alex@totalbiz.co.uk is set to Active and points to totalbizsupport@gmail.com.
- Step 3 (Emergency Forward Bypass):** If Cloudflare continues to hit 421 rate limits for critical emails, edit the routing rule in Cloudflare to forward to an alternative backup inbox (e.g., GMX or Outlook), then switch back once Gmail's throttle clears.

1. System Architecture Overview

Your business email runs on a hybrid cost-optimized architecture, separating inbound forwarding from outbound sending to ensure maximum deliverability without monthly mailbox costs.

Inbound Workflow (Receiving)

Path: Sender → Cloudflare Email Routing → Gmail

- Someone emails alex@totalbiz.co.uk.
- Cloudflare MX records intercept the email.
- Cloudflare forwards the raw message instantly to totalbizsupport@gmail.com.

Outbound Workflow (Sending)

Path: Gmail → Brevo SMTP Relay → Recipient Inbox

- You click "Compose" in Gmail using sender Alex Poxon | TotalBiz.
- Gmail routes the email to Brevo on Port 587 (TLS).
- Brevo applies custom DKIM/SPF signatures for totalbiz.co.uk and delivers the mail.

2. Official DNS Configuration (Cloudflare)

All authoritative DNS records for totalbiz.co.uk are managed inside Cloudflare DNS. Below is the exact active record map:

Type	Name / Host	Content / Target	Purpose
TXT	totalbiz.co.uk (@)	v=spf1 include:_spf.mx.cloudflare.net include:spf.brevo.com ~all	SPF (Cloudflare + Brevo)
CNAME	mail._domainkey	mail._domainkey.brevo.com (or Brevo target)	Brevo DKIM Signature

Type	Name / Host	Content / Target	Purpose
TXT	_dmarc	v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:rua@brevo.com;	DMARC Policy
MX	totalbiz.co.uk (@)	route1.mx.cloudflare.net (Priority 10)	Cloudflare Inbound Routing
MX	totalbiz.co.uk (@)	route2.mx.cloudflare.net (Priority 20)	Cloudflare Inbound Routing
MX	totalbiz.co.uk (@)	route3.mx.cloudflare.net (Priority 30)	Cloudflare Inbound Routing

3. SMTP & Gmail "Send Mail As" Configuration

Gmail Outbound SMTP Settings

SMTP Server:	smtp-relay.brevo.com
Port / Encryption:	587 TLS (Secured connection)
SMTP Username:	Dedicated Brevo Relay ID (e.g., b4c566001@smtp-brevo.com)
SMTP Password:	Brevo Generated Master SMTP Key (xsmtpsib-...) — Set to No Expiration
Sender Display Name:	Alex Poxon TotalBiz (Exactly 20 characters — fits mobile perfectly)
Sender Email:	alex@totalbiz.co.uk

4. Google Calendar, Meet & Drive Integration

To ensure calendar invitations, Google Meet calls, and Google Drive document shares sent to alex@totalbiz.co.uk seamlessly tie directly into your primary Google account without requiring a paid Workspace subscription:

Google Account Alternate Email Verification

- **Verified Alternate Email:** alex@totalbiz.co.uk is linked as an Alternate Email under **myaccount.google.com** > *Personal Info* > *Contact Info*.
- **Google Drive:** When someone shares a document with alex@totalbiz.co.uk, it automatically appears under your "Shared with me" tab in Google Drive.
- **Google Calendar & Meet:** Calendar invites sent to your custom address will populate directly onto your Google Calendar schedule.
- **Note on Verification Workaround:** If you ever need to re-verify this in the future and Cloudflare hits a 421 throttle, temporarily switch Cloudflare forwarding to a non-Gmail address (e.g., GMX), receive the link, verify, and switch Cloudflare back to Gmail.

5. Troubleshooting Matrix

Issue: Outbound email fails in Gmail with "535 Authentication Failed" error

Cause: Gmail was configured using your Gmail password or personal email address instead of Brevo's dedicated SMTP credentials.

Fix: Go to Gmail Settings > *Accounts and Import* > *Edit Info* next to `alex@totalbiz.co.uk`. Re-enter your Brevo SMTP Relay Username (e.g. `b4c566001@smtp-brevo.com`) and your generated Brevo SMTP Key (`xsmtpsib-...`) with Port **587 (TLS)**.

Issue: Recipients see red warnings or emails land in recipient Spam

Cause: Brevo sender misconfiguration or broken DKIM alignment.

Fix: Log into Brevo > **Senders**. Ensure `alex@totalbiz.co.uk` is listed as verified with green checkmarks for both DKIM and DMARC. Remove any generic `@gmail.com` senders from Brevo.

Issue: "Unauthorized IP address" banner warning in Brevo

Fix: Keep **"Block unauthorized IP addresses"** **DEACTIVATED** inside Brevo. Gmail sends mail from dynamic cloud IP ranges; enabling IP restrictions will instantly block Gmail from sending your emails.